

delivery sector that have cropped to support the rising stars of ecommerce. Delihivery, Rivigo, Locus, Locanix, BlackBuck and the latest, ElasticRun all offer disruptive, technology based logistic solutions. Many of them are also used by giants like Amazon and Flipkart.

Then, on the other hand, you have the entrenched incumbents like FedEx, Blue Dart, Gati even the erstwhile Indian Postal Services (before you dismiss it, know that even Amazon uses it more often than you would think).

At Every Step Ask Yourself- WWAD What Would Amazon Do?

The Big Daddy-O of ecommerce, Amazon needs no introduction. Not unless you have been living under a rock for better half of the past decade. It is globally one of the biggest ecommerce store and has inspired the local ecommerce giant Flipkart. These 2 companies control the lion's share of the Indian ecommerce industry. Both of them have built a highly robust and competitive online marketplace and their practices and standards are regularly used as a blueprint by aspiring entrepreneurs.

At this point, they have shipping and logistics down to a science. Both of them have built their own logistics and delivery systems having invested millions of rupees in warehouses, logistics assets, technology, manpower etc. Moreover, this has become a separate business for them under the banners of Amazon transportation services and Ekart (Flipkart). These services are also offered to other ecommerce businesses as third party logistics service providers. They partner with small vehicle owners to handle the last mile delivery and they provide the technological support and a somewhat steady income stream for these partners. This setup ensures that their transportation costs are low, errors are minimised and appropriate branding is done.

A two word takeaway at the end of the day is Research and Planning. Pay special attention to your shipping and logistics needs and you will go a long way (no pun intended). **d**



Kind of spoilt for choice here aren't you?